

French A1 — Course Syllabus

Crescere | Beginner French

Course at a Glance

Duration	12 weeks
Sessions	24 live sessions (2 per week)
Session length	1 hour each
Format	Live, small group via Google Meet
Homework	Approximately 20–30 minutes after each class
Prerequisites	None

Who This Course Is For

This course is designed for:

- **Absolute beginners** — no prior French required
- **Returning learners** — studied French years ago and want to rebuild
- **Motivated adults and college students** who want to speak, not just memorize grammar rules
- **High school and AP students** who want to strengthen their spoken French alongside their coursework (parent or guardian involvement is welcome where appropriate)

You do not need to know the French alphabet, any French words, or anything about French grammar before Session 1. The course starts from zero.

What You Will Be Able to Do by the End

By the end of French A1, you will be able to:

- Introduce yourself — name, where you're from, what you do — and ask others the same
- Describe people, places, and situations using the right words and endings
- Talk about your daily routine, your family, and your home
- Navigate real situations: ordering at a café, asking for directions, shopping at a market
- Discuss upcoming plans and express what you need to do, want to do, or can do
- Handle a basic pharmacy or health-related conversation
- Write a short personal message of 8–10 sentences in French
- Understand slow, clear spoken French on topics you have studied

A word on expectations: A1 is a solid beginner foundation. You will not be fluent at the end of this course. You will, however, have enough French to handle real situations and the skills to keep improving.

Course Philosophy

Speaking starts in Session 1. You will say French words out loud in your very first class. The course is built around doing, not just studying.

Grammar supports conversation. You will learn grammar, but in the order it helps you say things — not in the order of a textbook. Grammar rules are always introduced alongside the phrases that use them.

Mistakes are expected. Every person in your cohort is a beginner. Your instructor expects mistakes. The only thing that slows progress is staying quiet.

Homework is short and consistent. Each assignment is designed to fit in 20–30 minutes. The goal is daily repetition — especially speaking aloud — not hours of study.

Active participation is required. This is a live course, not a video series. You will be asked to speak, answer questions, and practice with other students in every session.

12-Week Course Outline

Week	Theme	What you will practice saying	Grammar focus
1	Sounds and greetings	Greet someone; introduce yourself; count to 100	<i>Être</i> (to be); formal vs. informal register
2	Describing people	Describe someone's appearance and personality	<i>Avoir</i> (to have); adjective agreement
3	Regular verbs and daily routine	Talk about your day using common verbs; practise your first reflexive phrases	Regular -er verbs; negation; first reflexive phrases (introduction)
4	Reflexive verbs and daily routine	Narrate your complete morning-to-evening routine; use sequencing words and basic clock times	Reflexive verbs; sequencing words; basic clock times
5	Getting around a city	Ask for and give directions; navigate transport in a French-speaking city	Prepositions of place; <i>aller</i> (to go); transportation
6	Cafés and restaurants	Order food and drink; navigate a restaurant	Partitive articles (<i>du, de la, des</i>); <i>vouloir</i>
7	Shopping	Shop for clothes; buy food at a market	Demonstratives (<i>ce, cette, ces</i>); quantities
8	Home and neighborhood	Describe where you live	<i>Il y a</i> ; location prepositions
9	Plans and obligations	Talk about what you are going to do; say what you must or can do	<i>Aller</i> + infinitive; modal verbs
10	Hobbies and leisure	Talk about your interests and free time	<i>Jouer à; faire de</i> ; frequency adverbs
11	Health and the body	Describe how you feel; navigate a pharmacy	Body vocabulary; <i>avoir mal à</i>
12	Review and final performance	Everything from weeks 1–11 in real scenarios	Full A1 integration

Homework Expectations

After most sessions, you will receive a short homework assignment. Typical assignments include:

- **Speaking practice** — saying a phrase, dialogue, or introduction out loud at home, multiple times
- **Short writing** — 4–8 sentences on a familiar topic from that week
- **Vocabulary review** — reading through a word list and practicing pronunciation
- **Numbers or grammar drills** — usually a short written exercise with an answer key so you can check yourself

Homework is designed to stay under 30 minutes. If something consistently takes longer, let the instructor know.

The most important habit to build is **speaking aloud**, not silently. Reading French in your head and saying it out loud feel completely different. The homework is designed to make you speak.

Assessment and Feedback

This is not a high-pressure exam course. You will not receive letter grades on each assignment.

Formative checks happen at five points during the course (after weeks 1, 5, 7, 9, and 11). These are brief spoken or written check-ins — usually 5–10 minutes — that help the instructor see where everyone is and what needs more practice. They are not graded. They inform how the following sessions are run.

Your instructor will give you feedback after speaking activities and on written assignments. Corrections are specific and targeted — the goal is always to help you say something more clearly or accurately.

Final Performance Task

At the end of Week 12, you will complete two short tasks:

Part A — Spoken role play (5–7 minutes) You and the instructor will work through a combined scenario: meeting someone, making a plan, giving directions, and describing a place. You will need to use the language from all 12 weeks naturally and in context. Notes are not permitted.

Part B — Written message (8–10 sentences) You will write a short note in French: introduce yourself, describe your daily routine, and suggest a plan for getting together with a French contact. This is done at home and submitted before the final session.

Both tasks are designed to show what you can do with French, not to catch you out on grammar rules. If you have attended class and done the homework, you will be ready for them.

Readiness for French A2

You are ready for A2 when you can:

- Give a complete self-introduction without preparation
- Use *être* and *avoir* in all forms without hesitation
- Conjugate regular -er verbs and the course's core irregular verbs (*aller, faire, venir, prendre, pouvoir, vouloir, devoir*) accurately; recognise -ir and -re patterns when you encounter them
- Navigate three or more real scenarios (café, directions, shopping) without looking things up
- Describe your daily routine in six or more connected sentences

- Talk about upcoming plans using *aller* + infinitive
- Write 8–10 grammatically sound simple sentences on a topic you know

A2 focuses on talking about the past — the passé composé and imparfait. A1 is the foundation that makes that possible.

Materials

What you need:

- A notebook or dedicated document for written work
- Reliable internet and audio/video access for Google Meet
- A willingness to speak out loud — including when it feels awkward

What is provided:

- Session materials and vocabulary lists (digital)
- Homework assignments (digital, distributed before each session)
- Pronunciation references and grammar handouts as needed

Textbook: No required textbook. If a supplementary resource is selected later, it will be communicated in advance.

What Student Success Looks Like

Students who get the most out of this course typically do five things:

1. **Show up to every live session.** The course moves at a set pace. Missing a session means missing the speaking practice — not just the content.
 2. **Speak during class.** Even when uncertain. Especially when uncertain.
 3. **Complete homework the same day.** The 20–30 minutes right after class (or later that evening) is when the material is freshest.
 4. **Practice aloud at home.** Reading French silently is not the same as saying it. Use your voice.
 5. **Ask questions early.** If something is confusing by the end of Session 2, it will still be confusing in Week 6. Say so.
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Specific cohort dates, meeting times, and Google Meet details will be confirmed before the course begins.

Crescere — French A1 | Questions? Contact your instructor.